SSC Simple Guide: What We Did and What It Means For You

This guide explains, in plain language, what was changed in one Phase 4 villa of our SSC community, why, and what it would mean for you if you wanted the same thing. It assumes no technical background. For step-by-step technical instructions, see the Technical Guide, or ask a technically-minded neighbour to walk through it with you. If you've never heard of Home Assistant at all, read What is Home Assistant? first.

> ⚠️ *WARNING: Electrical safety - please read first*
>
> Some of this involves wiring connected to **mains / line voltage electricity** (the same power that can seriously hurt or kill someone if handled incorrectly).
>
> - **Never** open a wall switch box, distribution board, or wiring panel yourself unless you are a qualified electrician.
> - Any physical/electrical work must be done by a **licensed electrician**.
> - The parts of this project that are safe for a non-electrician to do yourself are limited to: plugging in a small computer, connecting it to your home network, and using an app or web page. Everything involving wiring behind the walls is electrician territory.

> ❗ *IMPORTANT: Disclaimer*
>
> This guide is shared by a neighbour, for neighbours, as a community learning resource - it is **not** professional advice, and it comes with **no warranty**. Neither the author nor other contributors are responsible for any injury, death, fire, property damage, or other loss that may result from following it. This is a personal DIY project inside your own villa - community management is not involved and should not be contacted about it; help comes from neighbours who have already done it. Any electrical work must be done by a qualified electrician. Proceed at your own risk, and don't feel any pressure to do this yourself if you're not comfortable.

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What is TIS Control, and what did we replace?

Phase 4 villas in SSC, and possibly others, were built with a proprietary control panel system called **TIS Control**. It's a closed system from one manufacturer - it works, but you can't see how it works, can't easily extend it, and depend entirely on that one company for support and spare parts.

In one villa, we swapped out the "brain" of that system for **Home Assistant** - a free, open-source home automation platform used by millions of people worldwide. Nothing gets torn out to do this: the wiring behind your walls, your light switches, your motion sensors, and your air-conditioning are all repurposed rather than replaced. They keep doing exactly what they've always done - only **what's in charge** of them changes.

The best part: your devices already speak the right language

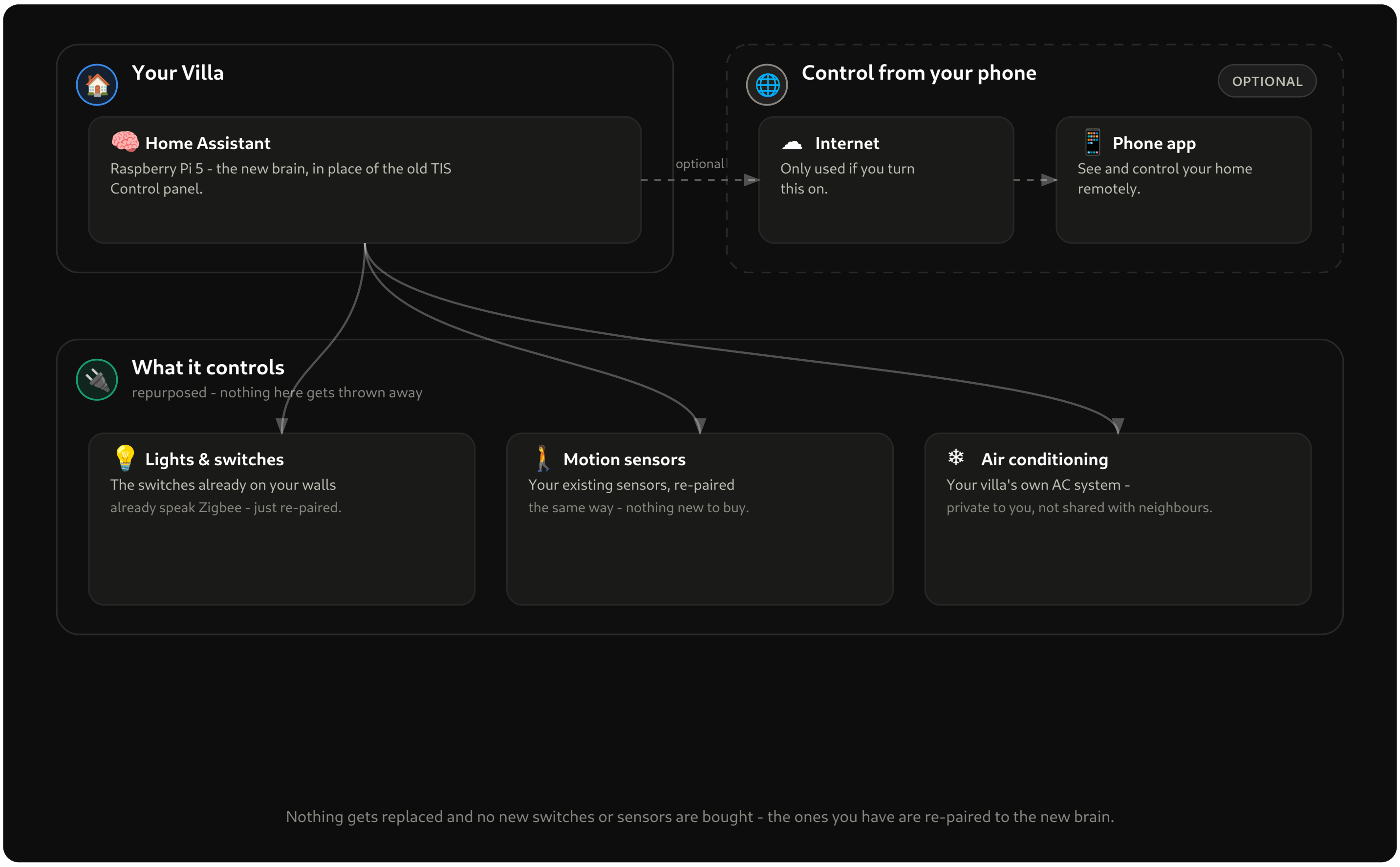
Here's the pleasant surprise that makes this project nearly free. The light switches and motion sensors TIS installed in our villas communicate using **Zigbee** - an open, industry-standard wireless language that Home Assistant speaks fluently. TIS used it privately; we simply introduce those same devices to a new brain.

So there is **no need to buy new switches, new sensors, or hire anyone to rewire anything**. The devices in your walls are simply "re-paired" - told to report to your new system instead of the old TIS panel. The only things you actually buy are the small computer and one antenna-like device, listed below.

What stays the same, what changes

- Your light switches on the wall still work as switches, exactly as before.
- Your motion sensors keep sensing, exactly as before.
- Your air-conditioning still works from its usual controls.
- You gain the ability to also control everything from a phone app, automate things (e.g. "turn off all lights at midnight", "hallway light on when motion is detected at night"), and combine devices in ways the closed TIS system didn't allow.
- You are no longer dependent on one manufacturer for support, updates, or spare parts - the software is free, open-source, and maintained by a large community.

The big picture



In plain words:

- A small computer (about the size of a deck of cards, called a **Raspberry Pi**) becomes the new "brain" of your villa, replacing the old TIS Control panel.
- That brain talks wirelessly, over **Zigbee**, to the same lights, switches, and motion sensors you already have - re-paired to report to Home Assistant instead of the old TIS panel.
- It also talks over your home network to your villa's own air-conditioning system (each villa has its own dedicated AC controller and unit - it isn't shared with neighbours), so you keep controlling the AC the same way you always did.
- None of this needs the internet to work day-to-day inside your home. Checking in on your villa while you're away is also possible - your technical neighbour can set that up for you; it's covered in the technical guide.

What you would need (shopping list, in plain terms)

This is the complete list - notice there are no switches or sensors on it, because yours are being reused.

Item	What it's for
Raspberry Pi 5 (the 8 GB memory version)	The small computer that runs Home Assistant - this becomes the new "brain".
A memory card of 64 GB or more, and the official power supply	Storage and power for the small computer.

Item	What it’s for
SMLIGHT SLZB-06M (a small Zigbee antenna box)	Lets the brain talk wirelessly to the switches and sensors already in your walls.
A network cable	Connects the small computer to your home internet router.

Exact details and where things plug in are in the Technical Guide.

How to get started, at a high level

1. Read this guide fully, and skim the Technical Guide so you know roughly what’s involved.
2. Decide whether you’re doing this yourself, with a technical neighbour’s help, or learning alongside them - this is a DIY project, so neighbours are the support network.
3. Get the three or four items from the shopping list above.
4. Follow the Technical Guide to install and configure the software, or have your technical neighbour do it with you watching/learning.
5. Re-pair your devices one room at a time - there’s no need to convert the whole villa in one day.
6. If a step ever seems to involve opening a wall box or touching wiring, stop - that’s a job for a qualified electrician, not a weekend project.

Getting help

This is neighbour-to-neighbour support, not a paid service, and community management is not part of it.

- Ask in the community WhatsApp group - the neighbours who’ve already converted their villas are the best starting point.
- Take it step by step - you don’t have to convert everything at once, and the old TIS panel isn’t damaged by any of this.
- Once you’re up and running, have a look at the automation library for ready-made ideas other villas are using - and share yours back.

> Reminder: anything involving live electrical wiring should be done by a qualified electrician. This guide is about the software and devices, not about giving anyone license to do their own electrical work.